

Realme C55

Fantastic battery life, performance could be better

Realme made all sorts of headlines with its Realme C55 smartphone – a budget phone with a clone of Apple’s Dynamic Island dubbed “Mini Capsule”. But does it deserve all the hype it has got? Does it match up to competition? Let’s find out!

BUILD, DESIGN, AND DISPLAY

Realme hasn’t just mimicked Apple’s Dynamic Island with the latest Realme C55 but the company also borrowed some other design cues as well. The sides of the Realme C55 mimic that of the latest iPhones with flat edges. The phone houses a capacitive fingerprint sensor on its power button which was a bit inconsistent during our testing. You also get a 3.5 mm audio jack but there’s only a mono speaker setup, which is disappointing. However, the single speaker is quite loud. Overall, we liked the build of the Realme C55, but in our opinion, the Poco M5 is better-designed in the same price bracket. Moving on to the display, the 90 Hz refresh rate provides for smooth scrolling experience but the display’s viewing angles are quite mediocre. We recorded about 265 nits of peak brightness on Auto Brightness under sunlight, which is low. So, screen legibility on bright days will definitely be an issue.

PERFORMANCE

Despite having 8 GB of RAM, I did come across some instances where the phone lagged and stuttered, however, the device is still capable of keeping 6-8 apps open and running in the background, albeit with a bit of lag. You will definitely feel the slow speeds when you open games or transfer files thanks to the included EMMC 5.1 memory. In benchmarks, the Realme C55 performed decently. The scores are mostly in line with what you’d get on the Snapdragon 680 SoC, but at this price,



you also get phones with the Helio G96 or Helio G99 processors which perform better in benchmarking apps. For example, the Poco M5 and Infinix Note 12 Turbo. Benchmarks aside, the real-world performance of the Realme C55 is quite decent, but you will face some stutters from time-to-time. You can game on this device, but we recommend Low graphics settings to minimise frame rate drops. As for UI, you get Realme UI 4.0 based on Android 13 out of the box. There’s tons of bloatware and third-party apps here. I also faced some annoyances including Realme’s Personalised Search that kept pulling up the keyboard in the apps screen even when disabled. Mini Capsule – which mimics Apple’s Dynamic Island – is successful in pulling off the look but its functionality is limited. Right now, it also pops up to indicate battery charging or low power, but more additions should come soon, according to Realme.

CAMERA

The Realme C55’s primary camera performs decently well in daylight but

as soon as you throw a tricky shooting situation at it, the phone’s camera falters. The secondary monochrome lens has no real use other than B&W shots, and I feel Realme could have skipped it altogether. Daylight shots have good dynamic range for the price with vibrant colours, however, the images can look quite oversharpened. Well-lit indoor shots look decent but the detail can be a tad soft at times. Portrait shots have poor edge detection and the highlights in these shots are usually overblown. Low light pictures are quite noisy and grainy. You also get an 8 MP selfie shooter which doesn’t fare well, especially in low light. Overall, cameras are not the Realme C55’s strongest suit.

BATTERY LIFE

The Realme C55 houses a massive 5,000 mAh battery which performs very well in day-to-day use. If you only use your phone for 3-4 hours everyday, you can easily expect 2-3 days of battery life without a hitch.

VERDICT

The Realme C55 is a decent budget device with fantastic battery life. However, its cons outweigh its pros. This phone’s standout features are its battery life and fast charging. And, the fact that it can game mostly lag-free at Low graphics. However, it has a lot of competition in this price bracket. For example, the Poco M5 has a more powerful chipset and a classier design. And the Infinix Note 12 Turbo is also a great option with an AMOLED display and the Helio G96 processor.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: MediaTek Helio G88 | RAM: Up to 8 GB LPDDR4X | ROM: Up to 256 GB, expandable up to 1 TB | Display: 6.72-inch FHD+ display, 90 Hz refresh rate | Camera: 64 MP OMNIVISION OV64B + 2 MP monochrome | Selfie camera: 8 MP | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 33 W SUPERVOOC | OS: Android 13, Realme UI 4.0

CONTACT

Realme | Phone: 1800 102 2777 | Email: NA | Website: <https://www.realme.com/in/>